

Final Project Proposal

Part 1 - Introduction

Title: *Noun Verb Noise*

Category: Algorithmic sound--making generative machine (with conceptual ties to the Self-directed project category)

Description

Noun Verb Noise is an interactive poetry and sound generator inspired by *Dada* principles and the *Mad Libs* word game. The project explores the intersection of language and sound through playful randomness, absurd logic, and algorithmic mapping.

Participants will input words into the system mimicking a *Mad Libs* style template (nouns, verbs, adjectives, etc.). The system will analyze specific properties of these words like length, number of consonants, starting or ending letters, etc.) and will use the data it collects to control specific sonic parameters within Max MSP.

Each input will generate unique audio behavior. For example, the word length could influence the pitch range, and letter values could affect rhythm, certain letters could also trigger different presets that are connected to specific sound objects. Sound will be produced using a variety of different Max tools and I will include *Dada* library objects as well. Including the *Dada* library objects will increase the randomness and uniqueness of the sounds that are generated with this system.

The outcome is a living, unpredictable composition, a poetic machine where nonsense words translate into soundscapes that evolve, collide, and rearrange themselves in unexpected ways.

This project balances conceptual absurdity with technical experimentation, echoing the anti-rational spirit of Dada while embracing generative sound design.

Part 2 - Goals and Timeline

Main Goals

- Develop an interactive system that converts text input into real-time sound.
- Integrate *Dada* library objects to produce indeterminate and evolving sonic results.
- Explore the relationship between linguistic structure and musical expression.
- Demonstrate an understanding of algorithmic composition through playful experimentation.

Subgoals

- Design and implement a simple user interface for word input.
- Analyze word data (length, syllables, letters, etc.) and map these parameters to Max values.
- Connect analysis output to *Dada* and synthesis objects to generate dynamic sounds.
- Refine mapping logic for interesting and diverse sonic outcomes.
- Test multiple “poem” structures to encourage replayability and surprise.
- Optionally, include a visual or textual display showing how user input influences sound.

Timeline

- Week of Nov 3: Submit proposal and begin building base text input interface.
- Week of Nov 10: Complete basic text analysis and parameter mapping tests.
- Week of Nov 17: Integrate and experiment with Dada objects for sound generation.
- Week of Nov 24: Test system behavior, refine mappings, and add optional visuals.
- Week of Dec 2: Presentation and demonstration.
- Week of Dec 9: Final report submission.

Part 3 - Sound Exploration

The sonorities explored in this project will combine synthesized tones created directly in Max/MSP with procedurally generated sounds from the Dada library, including objects like *dada.bounce*, *dada.bodies*, *dada.kaleido*. Short recorded samples or noise textures will also be incorporated to provide additional timbral variation and unpredictability. These sounds will be

shaped and manipulated by mapping textual input data, such as word length, syllable count, or letter values, to control parameters including pitch, duration, density, and modulation depth. Melodic and rhythmic patterns will be generated through word-based randomness, creating evolving textures that respond directly to user participation and the properties of the input text. By layering multiple Dada processes, the system will produce complex, chaotic, and musically expressive soundscapes that reflect both chance operations and the playful absurdity inherent in the project's concept.

Part 4 - Technologies and Tools

This project will be developed primarily in Max/MSP, which will handle sound generation, data mapping, and user interface design. Standard computer audio hardware, such as an audio interface, speakers, or headphones, will be used for output, with the potential inclusion of a MIDI controller or microphone for live manipulation or sampling. The project will make extensive use of the Dada library, as I previously mentioned in previous sections, to introduce randomness, motion, and unpredictable behaviors into the sound generation. The Bach library will be employed when symbolic or score-based data manipulation is needed, supporting the structured yet flexible aspects of the system. Additional optional resources, such as CNMAT externals or the odot library, may be used to enhance data routing, text processing, and interactivity, while Jitter could provide visual feedback if desired. Together, these tools will allow the system to translate textual input into dynamic, evolving, and absurdly playful sonic outputs.

Part 5 - Inspiration

This project draws inspiration from several interactive and generative works that explore the relationship between language and sound. Projects like *Text Rain* by Romy Achituv and *WordSynth* demonstrate how textual input can be translated into dynamic audiovisual experiences, providing models for mapping words to sound in creative ways. The principles explored in my presentation on the Dada library also heavily influenced this project, particularly the use of chance, randomness, and playful unpredictability as compositional tools. More broadly, the project is informed by the Dada art movement itself, with its emphasis on absurdity, anti-rationality, and experimentation, which guides both the conceptual framework and the interactive design of the system. Together, these influences situate the project within a tradition of playful, algorithmically driven, and participatory creative works.